

08 Expense Claims Receipts Approvals

India-focused synthetic enterprise reference policy | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 January 2026

PROVENANCE: This is a synthetic reference implementation created for RAG development. It is not an actual company policy. Production use requires replacement with the adopting company's approved policy, limits, grades and approval matrix.

1. Scope, Purpose & Definitions

Purpose

This policy establishes a controlled framework for authorizing, booking, paying, documenting and reimbursing business travel and related expenses in India and for international business trips originating in India.

Business travel must be necessary, reasonable, economical and connected to an approved business purpose. Limits are ceilings, not spending targets.

Where this policy refers to an approved channel, supplier, rate card, employee grade or approval authority, the production organization must populate those values from its current controlled source.

Definitions

Business trip means approved travel away from the employee's normal work location for company business. Domestic travel means travel within India; international travel means travel crossing an international border.

Per diem means a fixed daily allowance where the applicable rate card permits fixed-rate reimbursement instead of actual documented meals.

Personal expense means a cost primarily for personal convenience, leisure or private travel and is not reimbursable unless expressly allowed.

Core controls

Employees must not split, duplicate or deliberately misclassify expenses to avoid a limit or approval requirement.

An approved expense must still satisfy the applicable policy rule. Manager approval does not convert a prohibited expense into an eligible expense.

Questions requiring live information such as airline schedules, current exchange rates or current tax law should be answered using the relevant live system rather than a static policy.

10. Expense Claim & Receipts

Submission

Expense reports should normally be submitted within 15 calendar days after the trip, subject to the organization's controlled finance deadline.

Each line should include date, merchant, amount, currency, category, business purpose and cost center/project/customer when applicable.

Receipts must be legible and attached electronically.

Receipts

Original or digital supplier receipts are required above the applicable threshold and for designated mandatory-receipt categories.

Airfare, hotel, rental car and visa expenses normally require supporting documentation regardless of amount.

When a receipt is unavailable, the employee must use the missing-receipt declaration and provide an explanation; additional approval may be required.

Tax invoices

GST invoices should contain required tax details when input tax credit is intended. Employees should provide the company's GSTIN to suppliers where instructed.

Tax treatment must follow current finance and tax guidance rather than assumptions in the travel policy.

11. Approval Matrix & Exceptions

Standard workflow

Employee certifies accuracy and business purpose. Line manager confirms business necessity. Finance verifies documentation, policy compliance and accounting treatment.

Premium cabin, above-limit hotel, exceptional transportation and unusual entertainment require the additional authority defined by the controlled approval matrix.

Exceptions

Exceptions should identify the rule, reason, incremental cost, duration and approving authority. Approval should be obtained before the expense where practical.

Emergency exceptions may be documented after the event where advance approval was impossible.

Disputes

Rejected claims may be resubmitted with additional evidence or escalated through the designated finance process.

Policy interpretation should use the policy version effective on the date of travel.